

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 33 and 34

The Murakkab Jarri in the Jumla Ismiyyah

1. The particular standing of the Murakkab Jarri

A *Murakkab Jarri* begins with a *Harf*, and the *Harf ul Jarrah* puts the noun that follows it into the state of *jarr*.

The basic point: A *Murakkab Jarri* is neither *Ma'rifah* nor *Nakirah*. That is why in a *Jumla Ismiyyah* it becomes **neither the Mubtada nor the Khabar**.

Recall that the *Mubtada* must be *Ma'rifah* and the *Khabar Nakirah*. A *Murakkab Jarri* falls into neither box, because a *Harf ul Jarrah*, though meaningful in itself, is neither definite nor indefinite.

2. The Muta'alliq

Definition: When a *Murakkab Jarri* — that is, a *jarr* with its *majroor* — is used in a *Jumla Ismiyyah*, it generally does not take the place of the *Mubtada* or the *Khabar*, but supplies **additional information about the Khabar**. In Arabic grammar this is called the *Muta'alliq*.

Although it relates to the *Khabar* in ninety-nine percent of cases, it is called and written simply as the *Muta'alliq* so as to avoid ambiguity.

In a Jumla Fi'liyyah: This same *Muta'alliq*, when it occurs in a *Jumla Fi'liyyah*, is called the *Muta'alliq ul Fi'l*.

3. Examples of the Muta'alliq

عَلَى النِّسَاءِ	قَوَّامُونَ	الرِّجَالُ
Muta'alliq	Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Men are the maintainers of women.

عَلَى كُلِّ مُسْلِمٍ	فَرِيضَةٌ	طَلَبُ الْعِلْمِ
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Muta'alliq	Khabar	Mubtada (Murakkab Idafi)
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Translation: Seeking knowledge is an obligation upon every Muslim.

مَنْ النَّوْمُ	خَيْرٌ	الصَّلَاةُ
Muta'alliq	Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Prayer is better than sleep.

مَنْ الْخَيْرِ	قَرِيبٌ	الْمُحْسِنُ
Muta'alliq	Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: The doer of good is near to good.

مَنْهُ	خَيْرٌ	أَنَا
Muta'alliq	Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: I am better than him.

Note the last example: here a pronoun stands in the place of the *majroor* within the *Muta'alliq*, and the rule for joining a pronoun to مَنْ was covered in Lecture 29.

4. The Asma' uz Zarf

Definition: In Arabic those nouns that convey the sense of time or place are called *Asma' uz Zarf*. These too are used in a *Jumla Ismiyyah* as a *Muta'alliq*.

The two kinds of Zarf

Kind	Definition	Examples
Zarf uz Zaman	one that states a time	قَبْلَ ، بَعْدَ ، الْيَوْمَ ، حِينَ
Zarf ul Makan	one that states a place	تَحْتَ ، فَوْقَ ، أَمَامَ ، خَلْفَ ، بَيْنَ

The well-known Zuroof

تَحْتَ	فَوْقَ	أَمَامَ	خَلْفَ	بَيْنَ
beneath	above	in front of	behind	between

Important rules

- The *zuroof* are generally used as *Mansoob*, that is, with a fathah.
- They often come as the *Mudaf* in a *Murakkab Idafi*, which means the noun after them is *Majroor*.

Why Mansoob?: In the terminology of *Nahw*, a *zarf* is in fact a *Maf'ool Feehi* — "that within which the action took place". And a *maf'ool* is always *Mansoob*. That is why a fathah comes upon the *zuroof*.

An example

تَحْتَ الشَّجَرَةِ	جَالِسٌ	زَيْدٌ
Muta'alliq (Zarf)	Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Zayd is seated beneath the tree.

Here *تَحْتَ الشَّجَرَةِ* is the *Muta'alliq*. *تَحْتَ* is *Mansoob* for being a *zarf*, and it is also the *Mudaf*; while *الشَّجَرَةِ* is *Majroor* for being the *Mudaf Ilayh*.

5. The Qa'im Maqam Khabar

Definition: Sometimes in a *Jumla Ismiyyah* the *Khabar* is omitted, and the *Muta'alliq* — whether a *Murakkab Jarri* or a *zarf* — completes the sense by itself. In such a case the *Muta'alliq* is called the *Qa'im Maqam Khabar*, the stand-in for the *Khabar*.

The condition for omission: The *Khabar* is omitted only where the sense remains clear. If removing it would leave the statement incomplete — as in *الصَّلَاةُ مِنَ النَّوْمِ* — then it cannot be omitted.

Examples

زَيْدٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ	زَيْدٌ
Qa'im Maqam Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Zayd is in the mosque.

Originally this sentence was *زَيْدٌ جَالِسٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ*, "Zayd is seated in the mosque". The *Khabar* *جَالِسٌ* was omitted, and the sense still remained clear.

لِلَّهِ	الْحَمْدُ
Qa'im Maqam Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: All praise is for Allah.

مِنَ الْإِيمَانِ	الْحَيَاءُ
Qa'im Maqam Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Modesty is part of faith.

لِلْمُتَّقِينَ	الْجَنَّةُ
Qa'im Maqam Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Paradise is for those mindful of Allah.

لِلْكَافِرِينَ	جَهَنَّمَ
Qa'im Maqam Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Hell is for the disbelievers.

فِي خُسْرٍ	الْإِنْسَانُ
Qa'im Maqam Khabar	Mubtada

Translation: Indeed man is in loss.

A note on the terminology

In Lecture 30 it was said that a *Murakkab Jarri* can stand in the place of the *Khabar*, and the example **اَلْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ** was given. The finer terminology for the same thing has now come before us.

Both say the same thing: Put simply, one says the *Murakkab Jarri* became the *Khabar*. But stated precisely, the real *Khabar* is omitted and the *Murakkab Jarri* stands in its place — which is why it is called the *Qa'im Maqam Khabar*. Some books also call it the *Khabar Shibh Jumlah*. All three expressions point to one and the same reality.

6. Khabar Muqaddam and Mubtada Mu'akhkhar

In Arabic the order of a *Jumla Ismiyyah* is sometimes reversed: the **Khabar** is brought first and the **Mubtada** after it. This style is found abundantly in the Qur'an, and there is a rhetorical wisdom behind it.

Lahul Mulku wa Lahul Hamd

الْمُلْكُ	لَهُ
Mubtada Mu'akhkhar	Khabar Muqaddam

Translation: The dominion belongs to Him.

Element	Details
لَهُ	a jarr with its majroor, that is, a Murakkab Jarri. This is the Khabar Muqaddam
الْمُلْكُ	an Ism Ma'rifah and Marfoo'. This is the Mubtada Mu'akhkhar
The change of vowel	the pronoun in لَهُ originally carried an inverted dammah, but on being joined to the lam of الْمُلْكُ it was changed to a plain dammah

The deciding argument: The important point is that a *jarr* with its *majroor* can be the Khabar but never the Mubtada. That is why it is taken here as the *Khabar* and the other word as the *Mubtada*.

Likewise in وَلَهُ الْحَمْدُ لَهُ is the *Khabar Muqaddam* and الْحَمْدُ the *Mubtada Mu'akhkhar*.

The rule of vowels: Standing and inverted vowels become plain when read joined to what follows. This rule was covered in detail in Lectures 25 and 26.

7. The rhetorical purpose — Hasr

The ordinary order would be الْمُلْكُ لَهُ, "the dominion is His". But by bringing the *Khabar* first, *Hasr* has been produced in the sentence.

What is Hasr?: Hasr means confining something particularly to one thing alone. Put simply: producing the sense of "only His" or "alone" in the sentence.

Adopting this style brings force and emphasis into the translation.

لَهُ الْمُلْكُ وَلَهُ الْحَمْدُ

The whole of dominion belongs to Him alone, and the whole of praise belongs to Him alone.

Not always for Hasr: This style is not always for *Hasr*. Sometimes the *Khabar* is brought forward and the *Mubtada* set back for the **beauty of the speech**, and sometimes to produce **weight and balance** in the sentence.

A most famous example of Hasr

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

(Surah al-Fatihah: 5)

Translation: You alone we worship, and You alone we ask for help.

The ordinary order would be نَعْبُدُكَ, but bringing the object before the verb produced the same *Hasr* that is rendered by "alone" in the translation. This is a *Jumla Fi'liyyah*, yet the principle of bringing forward and setting back is the same.

8. Examples from the Qur'an

8.1 Surah al-Munafiqun, verse 7

وَلِلَّهِ خَزَائِنُ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَلَكِنَّ الْمُنْفِقِينَ لَا يَفْقَهُونَ

(Surah al-Munafiqun: 7)

Translation: And to Allah belong the treasures of the heavens and the earth, but the hypocrites do not understand.

خَزَائِنُ السَّمَوَاتِ	لِلَّهِ
Mubtada Mu'akhkhar (a Marfoo' Murakkab Idafi)	Khabar Muqaddam

Translation: The treasures of the heavens belong to Allah alone.

Here too *Hasr* is intended: the treasures of the heavens and the earth are set apart for Allah alone.

8.2 Surah al-Munafiqun, verse 8

وَلِلَّهِ الْعِزَّةُ وَلِرَسُولِهِ وَلِلْمُؤْمِنِينَ وَلَكِنَّ الْمُنْفِقِينَ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ

(Surah al-Munafiqun: 8)

Translation: And honour belongs to Allah and to His Messenger and to the believers, but the hypocrites do not know.

الْعِزَّةُ	لِلَّهِ
Mubtada Mu'akhkhar (Ma'rifah, Marfoo')	Khabar Muqaddam

Translation: Honour belongs to Allah alone.

رَسُولِهِ and الْمُؤْمِنِينَ are coupled to اللَّهِ — that is, honour belongs to Allah, His Messenger and the believers alone.

8.3 An example with a Zarf — Surah az-Zukhruf

وَعِنْدَهُ عِلْمُ السَّاعَةِ

(Surah az-Zukhruf: 85)

Translation: And with Him is the knowledge of the Hour.

عِلْمُ السَّاعَةِ	عِنْدَهُ
Mubtada Mu'akhkhar (a Marfoo' Murakkab Idafi)	Khabar Muqaddam (Zarf)

Translation: The knowledge of the Hour is with Him alone.

This example shows that the *Khabar Muqaddam* is not only a *Murakkab Jarri*; a *zarf* may likewise be brought forward and stand as the *Khabar*.

9. A Nakirah Muftada after a Jarr or a Zarf

As a rule the *Muftada* is *Ma'rifah*, but on certain occasions it may come as *Nakirah* — particularly when the sentence opens with a *jarr* and its *majroor* or with a *zarf*. This is an exceptional case.

The rules at a glance

The rule	Always binding?
that both the Muftada and the Khabar be Marfoo'	yes — it is binding
that the Muftada be Ma'rifah	no — exceptions exist
that the Khabar be Nakirah	no — exceptions exist
that the two agree in number and gender	no — exceptions exist

Reasons for bringing a Nakirah noun

There are several reasons in Arabic for bringing a *Nakirah* noun into a passage.

- to produce the sense of "a" or "one"
- to show the severity or gravity of something
- to convey the greatness or the contemptibility of something
- to state the abundance or the scarcity of something

9.1 Fee quloobihim marad

فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ مَرَضٌ فَزَادَهُمُ اللَّهُ مَرَضًا

(Surah al-Baqarah: 10)

Translation: In their hearts is a disease, so Allah increased their disease.

مَرَضٌ	فِي قُلُوبِهِمْ
Nakirah Muftada Mu'akhkhar	Khabar Muqaddam

Translation: In their hearts is a disease.

The purpose of the *Nakirah* here is to convey vagueness, contempt and dreadfulness. That is, in their hearts is no ordinary illness but a very great and grave one.

9.2 Wa 'ala absarihim ghishawah

خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ وَعَلَى سَمْعِهِمْ وَعَلَى أَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةً

(Surah al-Baqarah: 7)

Translation: Allah has set a seal upon their hearts and upon their hearing, and over their eyes is a covering.

غِشَاوَةٌ	وَعَلَىٰ أَبْصَارِهِمْ
Nakirah Muqtada Mu'akhkhar	Khabar Muqaddam

Translation: Over their eyes is a covering.

The *Nakirah* here means a covering exceedingly heavy and deep, which shows the severity of their misguidance.

9.3 In ordinary speech

Apart from rhetoric, in ordinary speech the purpose of this style is merely to give notice of **the existence of something**.

The sentence	Translation	The purpose
فِي بَيْتِي حَدِيقَةٌ	in my house there is a garden	the existence of the garden is meant, not any particular quality
لِي أَخٌ	I have a brother	merely giving notice of existence

Observe: In both these sentences too the *jarr* with its *majroor* comes first and the *Nakirah Muqtada* after it. It is this very order that makes a *Nakirah Muqtada* permissible. Were the order reversed, saying حَدِيقَةٌ فِي بَيْتِي would not have been sound.

Summary

1. A Murakkab Jarri begins with a Harf, and the Harf ul Jarrah puts the noun after it into the state of jarr.
2. A Murakkab Jarri is neither Ma'rifah nor Nakirah, which is why in a Jumla Ismiyyah it becomes neither the Muftada nor the Khabar.
3. In a Jumla Ismiyyah a Murakkab Jarri gives additional information about the Khabar, and is called the Muta'alliq.
4. Although it relates to the Khabar in ninety-nine percent of cases, it is called simply the Muta'alliq to avoid ambiguity.
5. This same Muta'alliq in a Jumla Fi'liyyah is called the Muta'alliq ul Fi'l.
6. Nouns conveying time or place are called Asma' uz Zarf, and these too come as a Muta'alliq.
7. The Zarf is of two kinds: Zarf uz Zaman, which states a time, and Zarf ul Makan, which states a place.
8. The well-known zuroof are: **يَنْ تَحْتَ, فَوْقَ, أَمَامَ, خَلْفَ**.
9. The zuroof are generally Mansoob, because in the terminology of Nahw they are a Maf'ool Feehi.
10. The zuroof often come as the Mudaf in a Murakkab Idafi, so the noun after them is Majroor.
11. Sometimes the Khabar is omitted and the Muta'alliq completes the sense; it is then called the Qa'im Maqam Khabar.
12. The Khabar is omitted only where the sense remains clear; where the statement would be left incomplete it cannot be omitted.
13. **رَزِيْدٌ جَالِسٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ** was originally **رَزِيْدٌ جَالِسٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ**, whose Khabar was omitted.
14. **وَالْحَمْدُ لِلّٰهِ, الْاِيْمَانِ مِنْ الْاِيْمَانِ** and **اَلْاِنْسَانُ فِيْ حُسْرٍ** all contain a Qa'im Maqam Khabar.
15. Sometimes the Khabar is brought first and the Muftada after it, which is called Khabar Muqaddam and Muftada Mu'akhkhar.
16. In **لَهُ الْمُلْكُ** is the Khabar Muqaddam and **الْمُلْكُ** the Muftada Mu'akhkhar.
17. The deciding argument is that a jarr with its majroor can be the Khabar but never the Muftada.
18. Bringing the Khabar forward produces Hasr in the sentence, the sense of "only His" and "alone".
19. This style is not always for Hasr; sometimes it is for the beauty of the speech and sometimes for weight and balance.
20. In verses 7 and 8 of Surah al-Munafiqun **لِلّٰهِ** is the Khabar Muqaddam, and Hasr is intended in both.
21. In **وَعِنْدَهُ عِلْمُ السَّاعَةِ** a zarf has come as the Khabar Muqaddam.
22. It is binding that the Muftada and the Khabar be Marfoo', but not that the Muftada be Ma'rifah and the Khabar Nakirah.
23. If a sentence opens with a jarr and its majroor or with a zarf, the Muftada may come as Nakirah.
24. In **فِيْ قُلُوْبِهِمْ مَّرَضٌ** the purpose of the Nakirah is to show the severity and gravity of the disease.
25. In **وَعَلَىْ اَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةٌ** the Nakirah points to an exceedingly deep covering.
26. In ordinary speech the purpose of this style is merely to give notice of the existence of something.

Exercise

1. State the reason why a Murakkab Jarri becomes neither the Muftada nor the Khabar in a Jumla Ismiyyah.
2. Define the Muta'alliq and explain why it is called simply the Muta'alliq.
3. What is the Muta'alliq ul Fi'l?
4. Write five examples of the Muta'alliq and separate the Muftada, Khabar and Muta'alliq in each.
5. Define the Asma' uz Zarf and explain both of their kinds with examples.
6. Write the five well-known Asma' uz Zarf with their meanings.
7. Why are the zuroof Mansoob?
8. Give a full analysis of رَزِيْدٌ جَالِسٌ تَحْتَ الشَّجَرَةِ.
9. Define the Qa'im Maqam Khabar and state the condition for omitting the Khabar.
10. Write six examples of the Qa'im Maqam Khabar.
11. What was the original form of رَزِيْدٌ فِي الْمَسْجِدِ?
12. What is meant by Khabar Muqaddam and Muftada Mu'akhkhar?
13. In لَهُ الْمَلِكُ, why is لَهُ taken as the Khabar and not as the Muftada?
14. Why did the inverted dammah of لَهُ become plain?
15. Define Hasr and state its purpose.
16. Is bringing the Khabar forward always for Hasr? Explain.
17. Separate the Khabar Muqaddam and the Muftada Mu'akhkhar in both verses of Surah al-Munafiqun.
18. Analyse وَعِنْدَهُ عِلْمُ السَّاعَةِ.
19. Which rules of the Jumla Ismiyyah are binding and in which are there exceptions?
20. Write all four reasons for bringing a Nakirah noun in Arabic.
21. What is the purpose of the Nakirah in فِي فُلُوْبِهِمْ مَّرَضٌ?
22. Write two examples of a Nakirah Muftada from ordinary speech and state their purpose.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ
اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ